

FACEBOOK IS BAD FOR PSYCHE

Late last year, a University of Michigan research and study concluded that using Facebook can reduce young adults' sense of well-being and satisfaction with life, according to a BBC report. The research that tracked participants' behaviour for two weeks concluded that "checking Facebook made people feel worse about both issues, and the more they browsed, the worse they felt." While the largest social network does a great job of connecting people, Facebook can have negative psychological consequences too. And their rate is increasing as more and people are embracing it and spend more time on it.

Web isn't all good

On the Web's 25th anniversary, according to a study by Pew Research Center, 15 per cent of Internet users feel that the Web has been bad for society and bad for them personally as well. The research group confirms noticing a trend of rising issues over the years that tend to gnaw at people about online life, according to Lee Rainie,



director of the center's Internet and American Life Project.

The Web is notorious for increasing the digital divide between the "haves" and the "have-nots", increasing instances of online bullying, encouraging to communicate only with like-minded people, and more. Major concerns abound regarding the Web's ability to spread misinformation, the loss of privacy, and the loss of real human contact in favor of virtual interactions, according to the study. Read more here: <http://dgit.in/1i7Ukcw>

Raising digital natives

Children of this generation are automatically digital natives, born in a world of smart-phones and the internet. Research suggests what we label as "addiction" to technology – with kids and infants – may actually be normal. However, care should be taken that kids interact with the physical environment around them to live and learn, and not just be stuck inside a house glued to a screen all the time (and get obese). A word of caution to parents raising kids in today's age, is to monitor kids' exposure to technology to prevent some of the obvious side-effects to getting exposed to too much too soon.

A research (funded by the European Commission's Safe Internet Programme) called 'Net Children Go Mobile' monitored internet activity among 9-16 year olds in Ireland, UK, Italy, Portugal, Denmark, Romania and Belgium, and found that double the amount of children surveyed said they had encountered upsetting things online than those surveyed two years previous. This needs to change, obviously.

factor of Kartik's life as real-life social gatherings, with friends, relatives, and even his own family started to reduce in frequency. Later when Kartik grew older and started working in the IT sector, he realized that he was getting sucked deeper and deeper into the rabbit hole. And any hopes of escaping it were fast evaporating. There was no end in sight from this cushy, comfortable existence.

Technology works against your health

Probably not right down to the tee, but all of us born before the turn of the century can relate to Kartik's story in some shape or form. It is probably the greatest irony of our times that in an age where technology is breaking new ground in every possible way, trying to make our life easier and comfortable beyond belief, us humans are ill-equipped to enjoy the benefits of all this technological wonder to the fullest, probably getting paralyzed by an overbearing dependence on it. And it's costing us our health.

Isolation, depression, stress, poor sleeping habits and obesity are just some

of the ill-effects of a lifestyle that hasn't successfully adjusted to its overdependence on technology and the digital age of the 21st century. Constant distraction, shortened attention spans, addiction and reduced eyesight and hearing are also some other companions of a life spent constantly plugged in.

There's a growing sense of concern amongst our race that technology has made our existence cushier, way more

WE NEED TO ANALYZE HOW TECHNOLOGY IS IMPACTING US, RIGHT FROM THE CHAIR WE SIT ON WHILE AT OUR PC TO HOW MANY HOURS WE'RE STARING AT DIGITAL SCREENS

comfortable than how we're supposed to exist and live in this world. There's an overbearing sense of fatigue on all things digital, and a recognition of its harmful effects on human health (in the absence of precautions and a balanced lifestyle, of course). The technological marvels we all heralded in raptures, hinged our cosy

comfortable existence on, are in fact contributing to our poor shape, deteriorating health and a myriad of physiological and psychological problems. Somewhere the lifestyle we're leading doesn't agree with our constitution. We need to bring about a radical change either in our life or the technology we're building to ensure mankind doesn't fall off the wagon and devolve into something pitiful or a mass of blob.

Somehow, somewhere, not just Kartik Kulkarni, but all of us who're glued to our smartphones, tablets, PCs, more than we should be, need a course correction. We need to learn to co-exist with the technology that we use without letting it adversely affect our mind and body. We need to reclaim lost ground, and there's a lot of work to be done on that front.

We need to put technology to work in ways that we shall remain untouched by its harmful effects.

And the answer doesn't involve unplugging yourself. Or throwing that smartphone or tablet away. Welcome to a new dawn in consumerized healthcare solutions that will help you reclaim your lost health back. 